SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #45 · MENTAL HEALTH AND SEEKING HELP

"I should be able to handle this on my own."

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Where it often comes from

Self-reliance is praised, and asking for help can feel like failure. Some learned early that no one would help, so they learned to cope alone. Pride and fear of burdening others also play a part.

What Scripture teaches

God said, "It is not good for the man to be alone." "Two are better than one." Paul writes, "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ." "He who isolates himself pursues selfish desires; he rebels against all sound judgment." Jesus invites, "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." Even Jesus asked friends to watch with Him. We were made for interdependence. Needing help is not failure. It is how God designed us.

> *"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ"* (Galatians 6:2).

Also see

> "The LORD God also said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.'" (Genesis 2:18).

> "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

> "He who isolates himself pursues selfish desires; he rebels against all sound judgment" (Proverbs 18:1).

> "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light" (Matthew 11:28–30).

Common self-statements

- I should be able to manage.
- Asking for help is weakness.
- I do not want to burden anyone.
- I have always handled things alone.
- If I need help, I have failed.
- No one will help anyway.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must be fully independent or a failure.
- Mind reading: Assuming I am a burden.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling that needing help is shameful.
- Fortune telling: Predicting no one will help.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn to handle things alone?

- Would I consider someone who asks for help weak?
- Who has helped me before, and how did they feel?
- What would I do if a friend were in my situation?
- What does Scripture say about bearing burdens together?
- What is one small request I could make this week?

Truth summary

> God made me for community. Needing help is part of being human, and receiving help blesses both sides. I can lean on God and on trusted people.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Pride
- Friendship
- Humility
- Loneliness
- Weakness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I should be able to handle this on my own"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I should be able to handle this on my own." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn this?
- ☐ Is asking weak?
- ☐ Who has helped me?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ What can I ask?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ It is not good to be alone.
- ☐ Two are better than one.
- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ Jesus invites the weary to come.
- ☐ Receiving help blesses the giver.
- ☐ I can ask.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9–10
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"
- ☐ Matthew 11:28–30
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ One request: Each week, note one time you asked for or accepted help.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Galatians 6:2 becomes: "Sarah can write: "We carry one another's burdens, so I can ask for help.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Humility" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Notice the pattern. Write how you handle things alone.
- ☐ Ask for one thing. Make a small request.
- ☐ Accept an offer. Say yes to help.
- ☐ Pray Matthew 11:28. Come to Jesus with your burden.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I should be able to handle this on my own": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One request
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I should be able to handle this on my own.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have carried this alone. Thank You for making us for each other. Help me ask, receive, and lean on You and on those You send. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.